

Organizational Confidence - Live Deal Test

Seven questions to test whether a live enterprise deal can survive the customer's internal approval process.

Opportunity

Stage

Seller

Review date

How to use the test

Use one live opportunity. For each question, mark the strongest status the evidence supports — not the status you hope is true.

CLEAR

Confirmed with the customer; evidence suggests the organization can defend the answer.

VULNERABLE

An answer exists, but it is weak, contested, incomplete, or may not survive scrutiny.

UNKNOWN

Sales does not know how the organization would answer, or the answer has not been tested.

Rule: If the answer is essentially “I assume they’ve dealt with that internally,” mark UNKNOWN.

The Seven Question Deal Test

#	Question	Status	Evidence / what we know	Stakeholder who can verify or resolve	Next move
1	Why change? What problem, opportunity, or business consequence makes the status quo unacceptable?	☐ C ☐ V ☐ U			
2	Why now? What creates sufficient impetus to act now rather than defer, wait, or reprioritize?	☐ C ☐ V ☐ U			
3	Why this approach? Why is this solution path preferable to alternative ways of addressing the need?	☐ C ☐ V ☐ U			

#	Question	Status	Evidence / what we know	Stakeholder who can verify or resolve	Next move
4	Why this supplier? Why are we the credible choice relative to competitors, incumbents, internal options, or doing nothing?	☐ C ☐ V ☐ U			
5	Why this investment instead of another? Why should scarce budget, attention, and resources be allocated here rather than elsewhere?	☐ C ☐ V ☐ U			
6	Why this commitment? Can the organization defend the implementation effort, disruption, dependencies, and ongoing obligations?	☐ C ☐ V ☐ U			
7	Can we manage the relationship? Is there confidence in governance, commercial terms, risk management, performance, and the ongoing supplier relationship?	☐ C ☐ V ☐ U			

Diagnose the Approval Gap

Do not average the seven answers into a percentage. The purpose is to identify the Vulnerable or Unknown answer most likely to stop, delay, or weaken approval — then act on it.

1. Most consequential Approval Gap

Which Vulnerable or Unknown answer is most likely to stop this deal being approved?

2. Evidence needed

What would move this from assumption or vulnerability to credible customer-side evidence?

3. Person who can verify or resolve it

Who inside the customer organization has the authority, knowledge, or exposure to confirm the answer?

4. Next conversation

What specific conversation, question, or action should happen next?

Manager Challenge

Evidence	What has the customer actually said, done, approved, funded, scheduled, or documented?
Survival	Could this answer survive scrutiny from Finance, Legal, Procurement, Operations, IT/Security, or another affected stakeholder?
Champion	Can the champion defend this decision without the seller, the deck, or a rescue call?
Impetus	Are the consequences of waiting or doing nothing clear enough for the organization to act?

Approval does not require unanimity. The decision must survive disagreement.

The goal is not a higher score. The goal is a stronger next move.